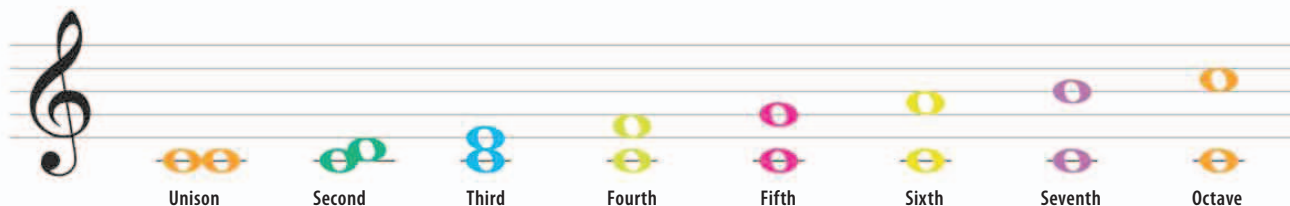


Intervals on the staff

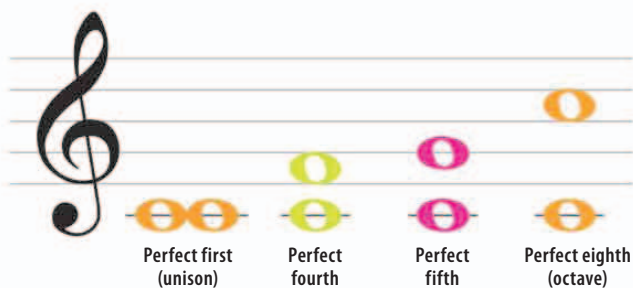
Here are the intervals of the C major scale written on the staff, when both notes are played at the same time. The bottom note of the interval is always Middle C, but the top note rises up the scale as the number of the interval increases.

- 29 ▽ **C major scale on the staff**
As the intervals increase from unison up to one octave, the top note of the interval rises through the eight notes of the C major scale on the staff.



Perfect intervals and major intervals

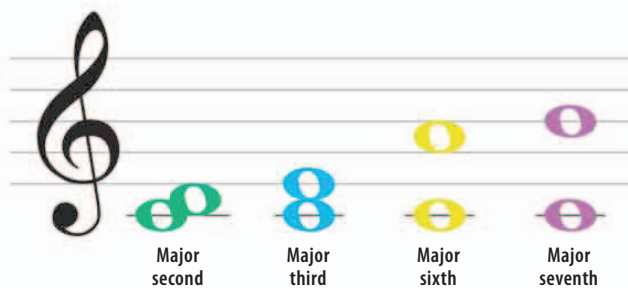
As well as being defined by their number, intervals are also defined by their quality—whether they are major, minor, perfect, augmented, or diminished. Some of the intervals of the major scale are called major intervals, and some are called perfect intervals.



△ Perfect intervals

The staff above shows the intervals of the major scale that are called perfect intervals. These are perfect unison, perfect fourth, perfect fifth, and perfect octave.

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△ Major intervals

The staff above shows the intervals of the major scale that are called major intervals. These are major second, major third, major sixth, and major seventh.

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LOOKING CLOSER

Octaves

An octave is the standard musical term for the interval of an eighth. Octaves are important intervals because they are the distance between the starting note and the top note of a scale.

▷ One octave

Going up the C major scale, the eight notes of the scale are shown on the staff. The interval between the top note and bottom note is one octave.

